Equal Shares and Square Grids

TEACHER KEY

2nd Grade Math · Interactive Math · Explore & Reflect

Get started

Cut circles and rectangles into halves, thirds and fourths, color the shares, and build rectangles from rows and columns of same-size squares. Open the tool and use it to answer each question.

Explore

1. Cut a circle into 3 equal shares. What is each share called?
   A third (one third)
2. How many thirds make one whole?
   3 thirds
3. Which is bigger: one third or one fourth of the same rectangle?
   One third
4. A rectangle has 3 rows and 4 columns of squares. How many squares are there?
   12 squares

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Explore more

5. Find another way to make a rectangle with 12 squares.

For example 2 rows of 6 (or 4 rows of 3, or 6 rows of 2)

6. Are equal shares of the same shape always the same shape? Explain.

No. Halves of a square can be two rectangles or two triangles — they are the same size, not always the same shape.

Reflect

7. Reflect: Why must the shares be the same size to be called thirds?

Thirds are 3 equal shares. If the parts are different sizes, they are not thirds.

Teacher notes

- Use Not equal parts as a non-example and ask students to explain why the parts are not thirds.
- In Rows and columns, ask students to predict the number of squares before they change the grid.
- Talk about “a whole” as 2 halves, 3 thirds or 4 fourths (2.G.A.3).

Standards: 2.G.A.2, 2.G.A.3. Accept any correct answer where several are possible, and ask students to explain with the tool’s picture.